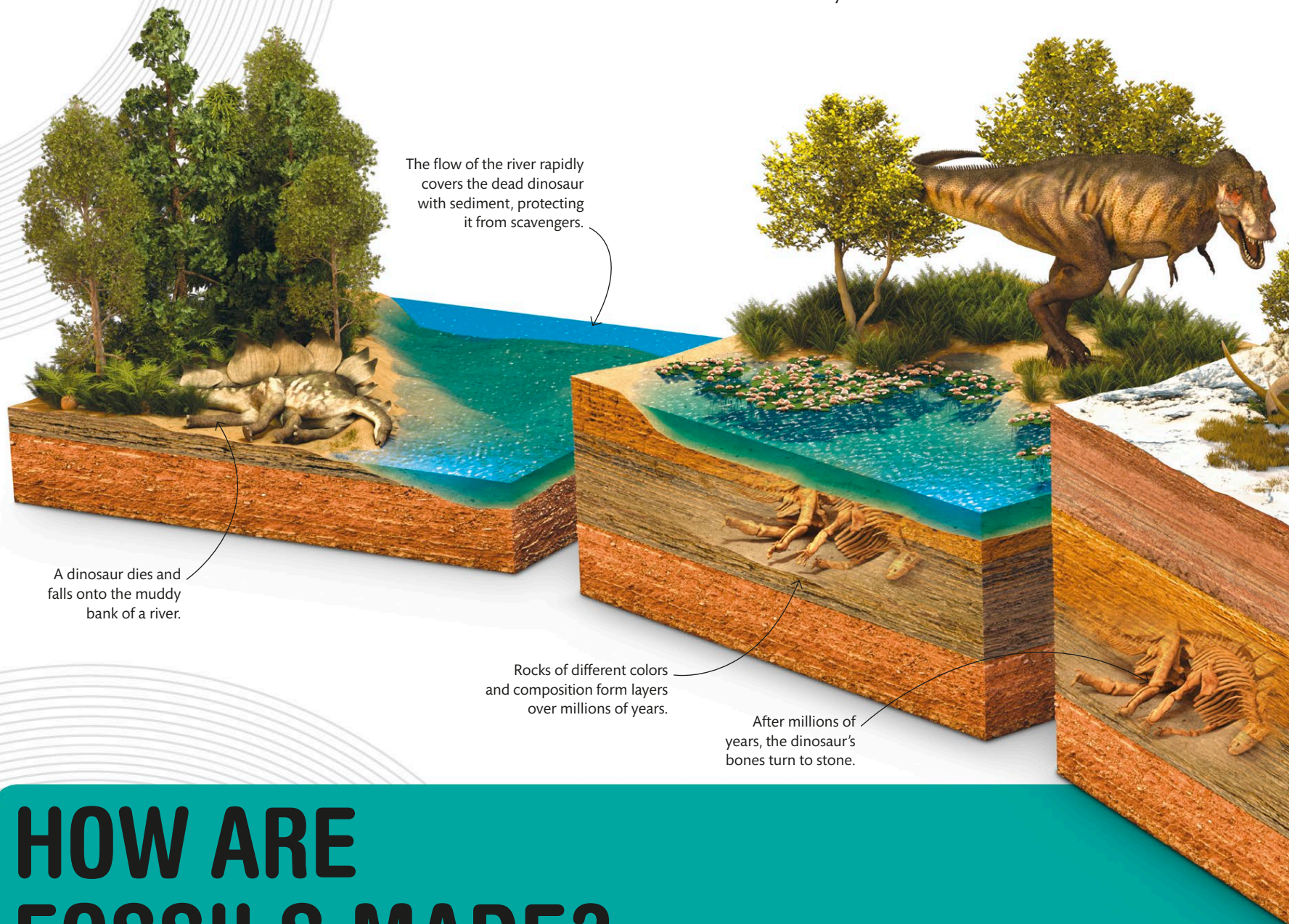


1 DEATH AND DECAY

To become a fossil, a creature's remains must be quickly buried before they are scattered by scavengers. Rapid burial slows down the rate at which bacteria break down the body, increasing the likelihood that parts such as the teeth or bones are preserved.

2 ACCUMULATION

As years go by, the dinosaur's body is covered with more layers of sediment. Under all these layers, the weight on top of the skeleton increases, causing great pressure. This creates the hard sedimentary rocks in which the fossils are found.



HOW ARE FOSSILS MADE?

A lot of what we know about prehistoric creatures comes from fossils. These are the remains of dead plants and animals that have been preserved inside rocks and minerals. However, fossils can only form in very specific circumstances, and most creatures leave no trace of their existence. Aquatic creatures or land animals that have been washed into a body of water and quickly covered by sediment are most likely to produce fossils. This is because they are protected from decomposition, erosion, and scavengers who might scatter an organism's remains. Large organisms with hard parts, such as a shell or a skeleton, also stand a good chance of producing fossils, as these tissues are more likely to survive the fossilization process.